

TRUE STORY · WEEK 3

The deal that almost didn't close because of a spreadsheet.

A short story about ballparks, sick days, and the one workflow assumption that costs more than anyone admits.

SWIPE →



THE SETUP

*A borrower came
in with a solid
fix-and-flip.*

Strong sponsor. Clean credit. A property with real upside in a market the lender knew well.

This deal should have been easy.

THE SYSTEM

*The lender's
pricing lived in a
master spreadsheet
maintained by
one person.*

Tabs, formulas, conditional formatting. The kind of file you don't dare break.

THE TWIST

*That person
was out sick.*

THE WORKAROUND



*I'll get you a ballpark — and
confirm by end of day.*

— THE LOAN OFFICER, IMPROVISING

THE OUTCOME

*End of day
came and went.*

The borrower didn't wait.

The deal **closed somewhere else** — with a lender
who could answer in real time.

THE LESSON

*They didn't lose
on rate.*

They lost because their pricing was **locked in a spreadsheet** — and the only key was a person who happened to be unavailable.

EZ RATE SHEET

*Pricing that
doesn't depend
on one person
being available.*

Always on. Always consistent. Quote the deal while
the borrower's still on the phone.

ezratesheet.com →